

the colonial era. Not surprisingly, Maharashtra got the highest Central sanction of Rs 3,439.92 crore under JNNURM, of which Rs 770 crore has already been released to it. So far, the Union Government has distributed Rs 3,906.30 crore for 198 projects sanctioned in the country.

Of the 97 projects submitted till February, 51 projects have been cleared by the central government. The total cost of all projects sanctioned for funding under the project in Maharashtra is Rs 7,528 crore. In keeping with this requirement, the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) started the Middle Vaitarna Project in 2006-07, which involves building a dam, a water treatment plant and creating new lines to augment water supply to the city by 450 million litres per day. Currently, Mumbai gets 3,350 million litres of water per day though the supply is not constant due to leakages, which cause contamination and loss of water for which the BMC gets no revenue. The Centre is committed to providing Rs 465 crore of the total cost of Rs 1,329 crore as the project has to be completed in four years. Says Manu Kumar Srivastav, Additional Commissioner of BMC, "None of the ambitious plans would have seen the light of day so soon without the JNNURM. Every project has monthly milestones and if the milestone is missed even by a percentage point then the project gets a zero. Such a tough grading system puts pressure on the boards to perform." Some ancient water supply pipelines too will be replaced both in south Mumbai and the suburbs. World class machines are boring tunnels into the city so that water can be moved from the source to the distribution centres. There are other projects simultaneously being rolled out in the state to add new roads and improve solid waste management in cities like Pune and develop drains in Greater Mumbai.

by Mallini Bhupta

FULL THROTTLE

Noida, Uttar Pradesh

UPGRADE OF ITIs

Budget allocation for 2008-09

Rs 750 crore

DISTINCTION

PASS

FAIL

"I am learning Microsoft Word and Excel and am sure I will get a job after completing the course," says Sunil Pal, 20, of Jalpura village, who is being trained in information technology at the Noida Industrial Training Institute (ITI), after completion of Class XII. According to the institute, officials from the Tata Group will come shortly to recruit skilled labour in various trades for the Nano car project.

The Noida ITI was established in 1984 to provide skilled labour to the nearby industries—so far it has produced 2,500 workers. The land was provided by the Noida Authority and the

THE WORKS: Trainees at Noida ITI



RAVI S SAHANI



A PRABHAKAR NAO

government spent Rs 20 lakh. When Finance Minister P. Chidambaram presented the first budget of this government in July 2004 he announced a plan to upgrade 500 ITIs. Noida ITI was chosen as one of the centres of excellence and Rs 1 crore has already been spent on its upgrade. Now they have been put under the public-private partnership scheme and committees will run them. ITIs are now getting more importance with the Union Government's announcement of the upgrade of 1,396 ITIs during the 11th Plan, with the help of World Bank. Of course, it is still small potatoes in a country with 5,114 ITIs.

by Shyamal Yadav